

Now recall our statement of the principle of sufficient reason:

The fact that there are
contingent things is
contingent.

Given the PSR, what assumption would be needed to get us to the conclusion that the fact that there are contingent things has an explanation?

Every contingent fact
has an explanation.

Is this assumption plausible? How might one argue for it?

The fact that there
are contingent things
has an explanation.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



objections
to the
PSR





containing things is

The fact that there are

conclusion that the fact that there are contingent things has an explanation?

Given the PSR, what assumption would be needed to get us to the



has an expiration.

Every continent has its own



has an expiration.

are continuing to thrive

The fact that there

... we cannot find in any of the individual things, or even in the entire collection and series of things, a sufficient reason for why they exist.

Let us suppose that a book on the elements of geometry has always existed, one copy always made from another. It is obvious that although we can explain a present copy of the book from the previous book from which it was copied, this will never lead us to a complete explanation, no matter how many books back we go, since we can always wonder why there have been such books.

What is true of these books is also true of the different states of the world ... however far back we might go into previous states, we will never find in those states a complete explanation for why there is a world at all, and why it is the way it is.



Leibniz's
argument



the
PSR



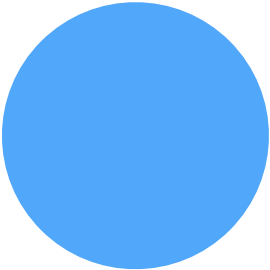
objections
to the
PSR

simply be some event, like the Big Bang, which is not a plausible candidate to

Last time we considered an objection to Aquinas' assumption that if a first

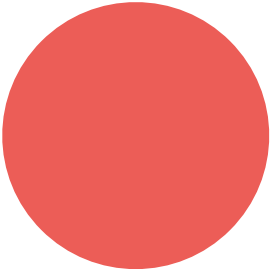
be Good.

cause exists, then God exists: the objection was that the first cause could



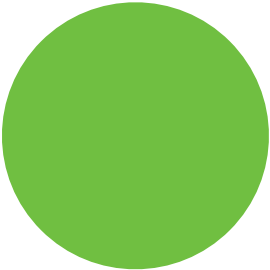


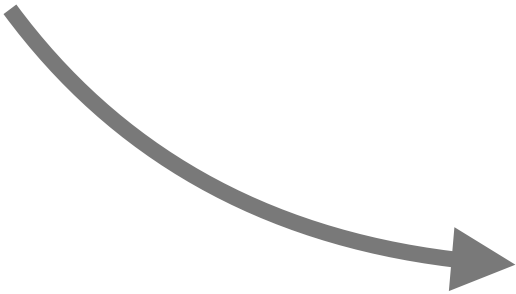


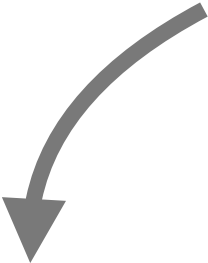














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